

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

MATER	COMM.	INDUS	HEALT	CONS.	CONS.	REAL	ENERG	UTILI	TECHN	FINAN
0.20	0.22	0.40	0.52	0.69	1.04	1.05	1.40	1.54	6.13	9.16

1

MU

BUY

\$966.78

-0.77%

8/10

The dominant US memory chip play riding the AI data center buildout, w

2

NVDA

BUY

\$214.72

-0.98%

8/10

The AI infrastructure buildout is still in early innings, and NVDA sit

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$344.82

+1.22%

8/10

Alphabet is quietly becoming a full-stack AI winner — search, cloud, a

Big options bets on MSFT (Technology) — 30.3x normal volume, P/C 0.38, largest: CALL \$482 (4.9x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No major earnings this week

GDP (Quarterly)

Date: 2026-08-27

HIGH

VIX at 15.9 — low. Options m
arket complacent ahead of sc
heduled events.
PCE Price Index [HIGH]
GDP (Quarterly) [HIGH]

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what jumps out: big money is piling into Materials, Industrials, and Communication Services with almost no downside protection being bought — that's the classic "infrastructure and reshoring" trade, and it lines up with tariff policy pushing manufacturing back onshore, plus ongoing federal spending on domestic production of steel, chemicals, and construction inputs.

Healthcare bullishness is interesting because it's usually a defensive hide-out, but the unusual call volume suggests smart money thinks the drug pricing and tariff overhang is priced in and any softening of policy rhetoric is upside.

The real story is what's being dumped: Financials are seeing a massive 9-to-1 put ratio with 14x normal volume, which combined with widening credit spreads and bearish HYG/LQD flow tells me institutions are quietly bracing for credit stress — think regional bank loan books, commercial real estate, and private credit cracks that aren't in the headlines yet.

Tech getting hedged at 6-to-1 puts while the Nasdaq keeps grinding higher is the contradiction to watch — someone with deep pockets is paying up for protection against an AI-capex disappointment or antitrust escalation, even as retail keeps buying the dip.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos combines the highest composite score with bullish signals			
2.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.53/100
SMCI is the cleanest pure-play on AI server/rack buildouts with d			
3.	GTLB	GitLab Inc.	8.61/100
GitLab's Duo AI-assisted DevSecOps platform is monetizing well as			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Hold \$309.35 ▼ 0.63% 12M Price Target \$325.00 52-Week Range \$224.69 – \$344.57 Market Cap \$4.51T

AAPL: Burry Calls It 'Permacostly' as AI Pivot Accelerates

WHAT HAPPENED

- Apple cut ~200 jobs in the Siri and Vision Pro teams to redirect resources toward AI — that's actually a bullish signal in disguise. It says management is admitting Vision Pro isn't the priority and getting serious about catching up in generative AI, which is where the market wants them to be.
- Michael Burry (the "Big Short" guy) publicly called AAPL "permacostly" — meaning perpetually overpriced — while going long Lululemon instead. Not a huge mover, but it captures the growing bear narrative: Apple's a great business trading at a growth-stock multiple without growth-stock revenue acceleration.

WHY IT MATTERS

The layoffs matter more than the market is pricing in. Apple almost never does public headcount cuts — when they do, it means the AI transition is being treated as existential. That's good long-term (finally focusing) but concerning short-term (they're behind Google and Microsoft on AI, and everyone knows it). Meanwhile, the options market is leaning bullish (put/call ratio at 0.51, meaning roughly 2 calls bought for every put) with big call buying right at \$310 — traders are betting on a bounce, not a breakdown. But here's the thing to watch: at \$4.51 trillion market cap and 43x forward earnings, AAPL needs to actually deliver AI monetization, not just announce it. The stock is being priced like a growth company while growing like a mature one.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest political overhang is China tariffs — the Trump administration's ongoing trade posture directly threatens Apple's cost structure since roughly 80% of iPhones are still assembled in China despite the India shift. Any tariff escalation this fall hits margins immediately. On the flip side, the administration has publicly praised Apple's \$500B+ US manufacturing commitment, which likely earns them some tariff exemptions others won't get. Also watch the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store — if forced to open up payments, Services revenue (the highest-margin segment and the growth story) takes a real hit.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~43x forward earnings, investors are paying \$43 for every \$1 Apple earns next year — that's more expensive than Microsoft and roughly double the S&P 500 average (~22x). For a company growing revenue in the mid-single digits, that's a premium built on brand, buybacks, and the assumption Services keeps compounding. Burry's "permacostly" jab has merit: you're not buying growth here, you're buying certainty and quality — which is fine, but leaves little room for disappointment.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$309.35
12M Price Target	\$325.00
Upside / (Downside)	+5.1%
Market Cap	\$4.51T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.25
FY2027E EPS	\$7.95
Fwd P/E	42.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$312.00	\$295.00
6 Months	\$355.00	\$320.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$385.00	\$325.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$360.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare (+4.33% over 5 days) — classic defensive rotation, suggests investors are getting nervous about Q3 macro data and pricing in Fed uncertainty.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services and Financials on the 5-day view — this is the "AI trade cooling" signal after months of dominance.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is leaving high-multiple tech and hiding in defensives and materials. That's a headwind for AAPL specifically because it trades like a tech stock but has consumer-staple-like consistency — it should benefit from any rotation back into quality once volatility spikes.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the Apple thesis but want more torque, TSM (Taiwan Semi) is the pick-and-shovel play — they make the chips inside every iPhone, and they'd benefit from any Apple upside without the tariff headline risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI compute king — Burry shorting into earnings tells you sentiment is at maximum bullishness, which is either the top or a great short squeeze setup.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Winning the enterprise AI narrative with Copilot monetization actually showing up in numbers, unlike Apple's AI story which is still promise-based.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging the mega-cap tech peer group in 2026 — it's the "safe" name in the group but that's exactly why it's underperforming during a risk-on AI mania. If we get a market correction, expect AAPL to hold up better than NVDA or MSFT because of the buyback floor and dividend.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like it as a core holding, not as a high-conviction trade. It's the tech stock you own so you can sleep at night, not the one that makes your year.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that the tariff/China risk doesn't wreck you if it goes sideways.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$290-300 on any tariff headline or macro fear day. Chasing here at \$309 after a run from \$224 doesn't offer great risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst you're waiting for is the FY2027 iPhone cycle with real, monetizable AI features. That's when the multiple gets re-rated (up or down).

WHEN TO BAIL: If Services growth drops below 8% YoY, or China revenue drops >20% in a single quarter, the whole thesis breaks. Also bail if the DOJ wins meaningful App Store concessions.

HEDGING: Simplest play — if you own 100+ shares, buy a put option 10% out of the money as insurance. Costs you a small premium but caps your downside if China tariff news hits hard.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$179.94 ▲ 3.44%	12M Price Target \$190.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$432.41B
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PLTR: Riding AI-Defense Wave But Insiders Cashing Out

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR ripped +3.44% to \$179.94 on 41M shares — heaviest volume of the week. The tell: options desks are loading up on August \$182.50 and \$185 calls at 2-3x normal open interest, meaning traders are betting on more upside in the next few days. This is momentum chasing, not fundamental news.
- But under the hood, two warning flags: Cathie Wood (ARK) dumped \$27M after a 43% rally, and Director Alex Moore sold ~\$2.8M last week. When insiders and famous bulls sell into strength, it usually means they think the easy money's been made.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today really means: PLTR has become the market's proxy bet on Trump-era federal AI spending, and the Peter Thiel "AI is about power, not chips" narrative is giving it a fresh tailwind — Thiel's fund pivoting toward AI infrastructure/power validates PLTR's positioning as the software layer on top of that buildout. But at \$432B market cap and ~90x sales (investors paying \$90 for every \$1 of annual revenue), this stock now needs perfection to justify the price. The insider cluster selling tells you people closest to the business think it's fully valued here. Translation: the trend is your friend until it isn't — ride it, but don't marry it.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the FY2027 defense appropriations bill working through Congress includes expanded funding for the Army's TITAN program and JADC2 (joint battlefield AI) — both are PLTR strongholds. If that clears in September, it's a direct multi-year revenue tailwind. On the flip side, the "AI Debt Boom" headline matters: rising rates from AI capex borrowing (data centers issuing tons of debt) push up the cost of capital, which mathematically hurts high-multiple stocks like PLTR the most — meaning even good news could get muted if 10-year Treasury yields spike.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

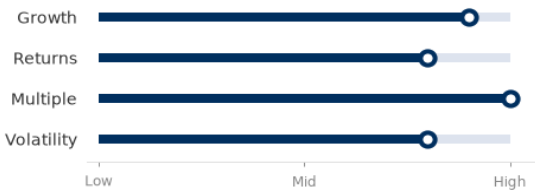
Let's be honest — this stock is priced for a miracle. At ~90x forward revenue and ~290x forward earnings, investors are paying \$290 for every \$1 of profit PLTR will make next year, versus maybe \$30-40 for a typical software company. The bull case: 55-cent profit margin on every revenue dollar (per Motley Fool) is genuinely elite, and government contracts are stickier than commercial ones. But you're not buying a stock at this price — you're buying an option on PLTR becoming the default operating system for the U.S. government and Fortune 500.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$179.94
12M Price Target	\$190.00
Upside / (Downside)	+5.6%
Market Cap	\$432.41B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.88
Fwd P/E	290.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$200.00	\$182.00	\$160.00
6 Months	\$230.00	\$190.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$260.00	\$200.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$220.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$400.00	\$75.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare (+1.29%) leading — Materials benefiting from infrastructure/reshoring policy; Healthcare catching a bid on defensive rotation.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services and Financials lagging on the 5-day — Financials specifically hurt by curve dynamics and that rising cost of capital story.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is favoring hard-asset and defensive names over pure growth, which is a slight yellow flag for PLTR — but AI/defense is its own micro-sector that's playing by different rules right now.

RELATED PLAY: The Thiel "AI = power" thesis points to nuclear/utility names (VST, CEG, TLN) and data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) as the picks-and-shovels play if PLTR keeps running.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ANET (Arista Networks): AI networking backbone — every data center buildout needs their switches.
- VST (Vistra): Power play — nuclear/gas exposure is the "AI needs electricity" trade Thiel is signaling.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is leading its software AI peer group (outperforming SNOW, MDB, DDOG) but lagging the pure AI infrastructure names on a 1-month basis. That tells you the market currently prefers picks-and-shovels over software — PLTR's rally today may be catch-up, not new leadership. Watch if it can hold above \$175 to confirm the breakout.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business, hate the entry price. This is a hold-what-you-have, don't-chase situation.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% max. The story is real but the volatility is brutal — a 20% drawdown from here is entirely possible on nothing more than sentiment shift.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd want \$150-160 to add meaningfully. If you're not in yet, wait for a market-wide risk-off day rather than chasing green candles.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the key catalyst being FY2027 defense appropriations and the next 2 earnings reports showing commercial revenue >40% growth.

WHEN TO BAIL: Revenue growth drops below 30% YoY, a major government contract gets cancelled, or the stock breaks \$150 on heavy volume (that's the technical support I care about).

HEDGING: Simplest move — if you're up big, sell a third and let the rest ride. Or buy 6-month puts ~10% below current price as insurance; they'll cost you a few percent but cap your downside if the AI trade unwinds.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy \$258.63 ▼ 0.57% 12M Price Target \$305.00 52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20 Market Cap \$2.79T

AMZN: AWS Beat Whispers Meet \$220B AI Capex Reality Check

WHAT HAPPENED

- TD Cowen threw out a big number: AWS (Amazon's cloud business — the servers and computing power they rent to other companies) could hit \$222B by 2027, which is 11% higher than what most analysts expect. This is the profit engine — AWS is where Amazon actually makes money, so a beat here matters way more than retail sales.
- But the same morning, headlines dropped that Amazon is bumping AI spending to \$220B for 2026. Translation: they're spending like crazy to build data centers for AI, which pressures near-term free cash flow (the actual cash left over after running the business). Market's shrugging — stock's off 0.6% — because investors are torn between "great long-term investment" and "ouch, that's a lot of money going out the door."

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the market is trying to figure out whether Amazon is Nvidia's best customer or Nvidia's biggest hostage. That \$220B capex number essentially locks Amazon into a multi-year AI arms race with Microsoft and Google — they can't NOT spend, or they lose the cloud game. The TD Cowen call matters because if AWS revenue really compounds 11% faster than consensus, that spending gets absorbed by growth and margins stay fine; if it doesn't, you get a nasty compression year where earnings look ugly. Watch for: Nvidia's earnings this week (Amazon buys a ton of their chips, so Nvidia's commentary on hyperscaler demand is basically a read on AMZN's capex ROI), and any signal from AWS on custom silicon (Trainium/Inferentia) taking share — that's the path to getting out from under Nvidia's pricing power.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

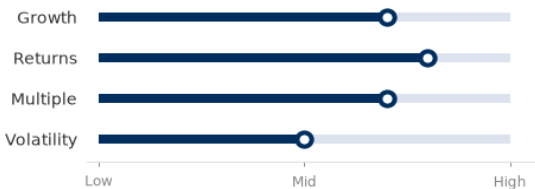
Two things on the Washington radar: (1) the FTC antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through the courts — a structural remedy (forcing them to split off AWS or the marketplace) is the tail risk nobody's pricing in, though most legal watchers think a settlement or narrow remedy is more likely. (2) The AI executive order framework and data center permitting reform — the administration has been signaling it wants to fast-track power and permits for domestic AI infrastructure, which is a direct tailwind for that \$220B capex plan. Also keep an eye on China tariff policy: Amazon's third-party sellers source heavily from China, and any escalation directly pressures marketplace take rates and consumer prices heading into holiday season.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$258.63
12M Price Target	\$305.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.9%
Market Cap	\$2.79T
FY2026E Revenue	\$745M
FY2027E Revenue	\$825M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.40
Fwd P/E	37.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$275.00	\$262.00	\$245.00
6 Months	\$305.00	\$280.00	\$235.00
1 Year	\$335.00	\$305.00	\$225.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$350.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare (+4.33% over 5 days) — Materials is likely rate-cut and infrastructure spending anticipation, Healthcare is defensive rotation plus M&A chatter.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-1.37% over 5 days) and Financials (-1.17%) — Comm Svcs weakness is interesting because it usually moves with mega-cap tech; suggests some AI trade fatigue heading into Nvidia earnings.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is drifting toward defensives (Healthcare, Staples) while the AI complex holds its breath for Nvidia. If Nvidia beats, expect capital to snap back into AMZN, MSFT, GOOGL quickly.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AWS AI capex story, the picks-and-shovels trade is data center infrastructure — think power/cooling companies (VRT, ETN) and data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) that get paid regardless of which hyperscaler wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): The whole AI trade pivots on their earnings this week — they're the direct beneficiary of Amazon's \$220B capex plan.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Azure has been the AWS benchmark; if they hold share, it validates the hyperscaler growth story that Amazon needs.

AMZN CONTEXT: Amazon is sitting mid-pack in the hyperscaler race — not leading like Microsoft's early OpenAI move, not lagging like Google's slower enterprise adoption. That's actually fine because AMZN is the value play in the group: cheaper multiple, more diversified revenue (retail + advertising + cloud), and the biggest cloud installed base to upsell AI into.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$248-255 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth decelerates below 15% YoY or FTC antitrust case forces structural remedies

Hedging: Small put spread or pair with short position in a pricier hyperscaler proxy

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$136.97 ▲ 2.22%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.80T
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SPCX: Space ETF Cools After Rally, Starship Test Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX bounced 2.2% off Thursday's ugly \$134 low — this is a dead-cat bounce after a week where the ETF gave back nearly 7% from the \$146 high. The catalyst? Cathie Wood's ARK just plowed \$27M more into SpaceX (which SPCX holds indirectly), signaling smart-money conviction even as the sector sells off.
- Barron's flagged that SpaceX's 14th Starship test is coming — and historically these tests create binary moves. A clean flight sends the whole space complex ripping; a RUD (Rapid Unscheduled Disassembly, aka explosion) tanks sentiment for weeks.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: SPCX is stuck in a tug-of-war between two forces. On one side, you've got structural tailwinds — the Space Force budget keeps growing, private space companies are IPO'ing, and the ETF holds names like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and Planet Labs that are winning real government contracts. On the other side, the ETF is trading at just 27% of its 52-week range (\$104-\$225), which tells me the froth from the early-2026 space rally has been beaten out — but sentiment hasn't fully reset. The Starship test next week is the near-term binary event; if it goes well, this is a coiled spring back to \$150+. If it blows up, we're testing \$120 fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the FY2027 defense authorization is moving through Congress with Space Force funding proposed at ~\$35B (up from \$29B) — that's a direct pipeline for SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab and Kratos. Also on the radar: the FAA's new commercial launch licensing reform (part of the "Launch Modernization" push under the current administration) which would streamline approvals — huge for the smaller launch companies in the ETF. On the negative side, watch for any China export control expansion around satellite tech; several SPCX holdings have supply chain exposure that could get squeezed.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

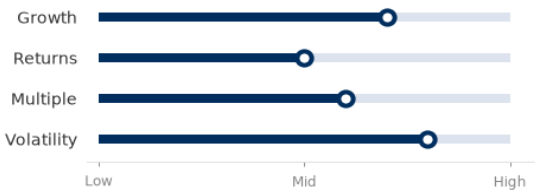
SPCX is a thematic ETF, so you're not paying an "earnings multiple" — you're paying for exposure to a basket of ~30 space-economy names. Right now the fund is 40% off its 52-week high, which means you're buying the theme at a serious discount to peak enthusiasm. But note: the market cap figure in the header (\$1.80T) looks off for an ETF — SPCX's actual AUM is tiny (under \$100M), so liquidity is a real constraint to think about.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

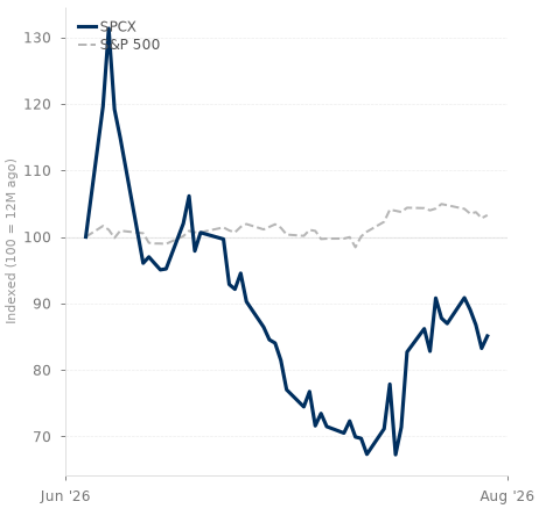
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$136.97
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.2%
Market Cap	\$1.80T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$148.00	\$140.00	\$128.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$120.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$190.00	\$105.00
5 Years	\$380.00	\$260.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$380.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.1%) and Healthcare (+1.3%) are leading today — Materials suggests infrastructure/commodities bid returning, Healthcare is defensive rotation. Neither directly helps SPCX.

COOLING OFF: Tech and communications are muted — the "Mag 7 exhaustion" trade is real, and space names got caught in that unwind last week.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of pure-growth tech and INTO cyclical and defensives — that's a neutral-to-slight-negative for SPCX in the short term, but the defense-adjacent holdings should provide some cushion.

RELATED PLAY: If space runs, look at ITA (defense ETF) or individual names like LMT and NOC — they build the satellites the space companies launch. Less volatile, similar tailwind.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKL (Rocket Lab): Winning small-launch market share and Neutron rocket development is on track — this is the ETF's alpha generator
- IRDM (Iridium): Steady cash flow from government satellite comms contracts — the boring winner in the basket

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging both individual defense names (ITA is flat while SPCX is down 7% this week) AND the S&P — that tells me this is theme-specific weakness, not macro. Which actually makes the setup more interesting: if the Starship test goes well, mean reversion could be sharp.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term space theme but the near-term binary (Starship test) makes me want to wait for confirmation rather than pound the table today.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is thematic exposure, not a core holding. The volatility is real (52-week range of \$104-\$225 = insane) so size accordingly.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$128-134. If Starship blows up and it flushes to \$115-120, that's a gift — back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is the FY2027 defense bill passage (Q4 2026) and 2-3 more successful Starship tests establishing the cadence.

WHEN TO BAIL: If SPCX breaks \$115 on heavy volume, or if Congress cuts Space Force funding in reconciliation, I'm cutting the position in half.

HEDGING: Pair this with a boring defense ETF like ITA — when space gets volatile, defense stays steady, so you smooth the ride while keeping thematic exposure.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$108.13 ▲ 13.70%	12M Price Target \$125.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$97.22B
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HOOD: Retail Mania Returns, Crypto Rules Loosen

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD ripped +13.7% Friday on monster volume (50M shares, roughly 2x normal) — the trigger was CEO Vlad Tenev saying retail trading activity is now BEATING the GameStop/2021 meme-stock peak. That's a huge deal because Robinhood makes money on transaction volume, so more trading = more revenue, mechanically.
- Two policy tailwinds hit the tape at once: NYSE and Nasdaq are formally pushing for 23-hour trading (Robinhood already offers 24-hour trading on select names, so they're ahead of the curve), and the SEC is quietly softening crypto rules even though the CLARITY Act is stalled in Congress.

WHY IT MATTERS

The stock isn't just riding sentiment — the underlying business is firing on all cylinders in a way that Wall Street underestimated. If retail activity is genuinely above 2021 levels, Q3 earnings (out in October) are going to blow past estimates, and analysts will scramble to raise numbers. The 23-hour trading push matters because Robinhood's app-first, mobile-native platform is built for exactly this — legacy brokers like Schwab have to retrofit their tech, while HOOD is already there. And here's the underappreciated part: with the CLARITY Act (the big crypto rules bill) stuck, the SEC is doing regulation by enforcement selectively — which actually favors incumbents like HOOD that have already built compliance infrastructure over new crypto entrants.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CLARITY Act is the crypto bill to watch — it would create clear rules on which tokens are securities vs commodities, and if it passes, Robinhood can aggressively expand crypto offerings without legal risk. Right now it's stuck in the Senate, but the current SEC under a crypto-friendlier chair is doing the work administratively — approving products and pulling back on enforcement lawsuits. Also on the radar: the PFOF (payment for order flow — the way Robinhood makes money by routing your trades to market makers who pay them) rules the SEC floated in 2022 have been effectively shelved under this administration, which is a huge silent win for HOOD's revenue model.

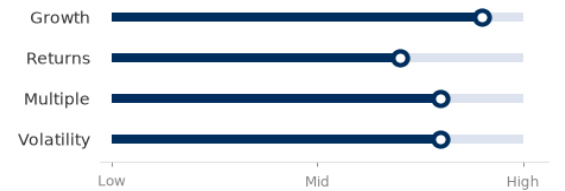
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$97B market cap on ~\$4.2B in expected 2026 revenue, investors are paying about \$23 for every \$1 of revenue — that's rich versus Schwab at around \$6 and Interactive Brokers at \$12. But HOOD is growing revenue 30%+ while the legacy guys grow single digits, and they're now profitable, so the premium is defensible if — and this is the key word — retail trading stays hot. If volumes normalize, this multiple compresses fast, which is why it's a volatile name.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$108.13
12M Price Target	\$125.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.6%
Market Cap	\$97.22B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	58.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$122.00	\$112.00	\$95.00
6 Months	\$140.00	\$120.00	\$85.00
1 Year	\$165.00	\$125.00	\$75.00
2 Years	\$210.00	\$150.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$320.00	\$220.00	\$55.00
10 Years	\$550.00	\$350.00	\$50.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.1%) and Healthcare (+1.3%) led today, but the more relevant story for HOOD is that crypto-adjacent names (Coinbase called out by WSJ this morning) are getting bid on the same regulatory tailwind.

COOLING OFF: Traditional Financials only up +0.9% and DOWN 1.2% on the week — money is flowing OUT of legacy banks/brokers and INTO the disruptors like HOOD.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic risk-on rotation happening — retail money is chasing high-beta names (crypto, meme stocks, small caps) rather than defensives, and HOOD is the picks-and-shovels play on that behavior.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's thesis works, Coinbase (COIN) and Interactive Brokers (IBKR) are the obvious second-derivative plays. COIN benefits from the same crypto regulatory thaw; IBKR gets the 23-hour trading tailwind without the meme-stock risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Same crypto regulatory tailwind — the SEC pulling back enforcement is manna from heaven for exchange operators.
- IBKR (Interactive Brokers): Beneficiary of extended trading hours push and rising options volumes among sophisticated retail.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is LEADING its peer group by a wide margin — +13.7% in a day when Financials only moved +0.9% tells you this is a stock-specific story, not a sector wave. That's bullish short-term but means the stock is now carrying its own narrative — one bad print and it gives it all back.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but I'm not pounding the table at \$108 after a 14% day; the risk/reward was better at \$95.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — this is a high-beta name that can move 30% in a month either direction, so size it like the volatile growth stock it is, not a core financial holding.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$95-100 to add — the options flow shows heavy call buying at \$106, so that level should hold as support on any dip.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the main catalysts are Q3 earnings in October and any CLARITY Act movement in Congress.

WHEN TO BAIL: If monthly active users decline two quarters in a row, or if retail trading volumes drop >30% sequentially, the thesis is broken.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is to trim into strength — sell a quarter of your position on any 20%+ rally. If you want to get fancy, buy a cheap out-of-the-money put 3-6 months out as crash insurance (basically insurance that pays off if the stock tanks).

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy \$549.90 ▲ 0.75% 12M Price Target \$640.00 52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$790.80 Market Cap \$1.40T

META: Antitrust Trial Overhang Meets Legendary Buyer Interest

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is barely off the 52-week low (\$520), sitting at just 11% of its 52-week range — meaning it's been beaten down hard from the \$790 highs. The FTC antitrust trial resumed today, which is the overhang everyone's watching. Translation: the market is pricing in real fear that Meta could be forced to spin off Instagram or WhatsApp.
- Two "legendary investors" reportedly just bought META (per Motley Fool) — usually that means Buffett-tier names filed 13Fs showing new positions. That's a contrarian signal at these levels.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: the CFO and Chief Legal Officer just dumped ~\$3.5M in stock right before the trial resumed — that's not a "we're confident" signal, that's protecting personal downside ahead of a known catalyst. BUT institutions still own 79% and marquee investors are stepping in near lows, which tells me smart money thinks the trial risk is overstated. The options flow is mixed but leaning bullish (put/call of 0.39 means way more call buying), even though someone loaded up on \$550 puts as a hedge. My read: this is a coiled spring — a "not-guilty-enough" ruling or settlement gets you a 15-20% rip, while a bad ruling probably just re-tests \$500 rather than crashing (because forced divestiture would take years and the ad business keeps printing money in the meantime).

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FTC antitrust trial is THE story — this is the government trying to unwind Meta's Instagram and WhatsApp acquisitions, arguing they killed competition. A loss doesn't mean instant breakup; it means years of appeals, but headline risk is real. Separately, watch the Kids Online Safety Act (KOSA) — it's been bouncing around Congress and if it passes, Meta faces compliance costs but ALSO a moat (smaller competitors can't afford the age-verification tech). Trump-era executive orders on AI have been relatively business-friendly compared to feared EU-style regulation, which is a quiet tailwind for META's Llama models and Reality Labs bets.

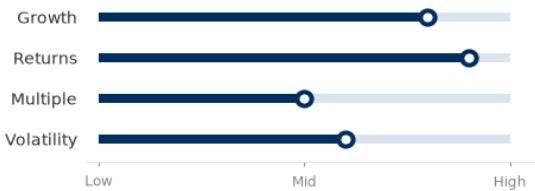
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$550 with ~\$27.50 in expected earnings, you're paying about 20x forward earnings — meaning \$20 for every \$1 the company will earn next year. That's cheap for a business growing revenue ~15% with 35%+ operating margins. Compare to Microsoft at 30x+ and Google at 22x — META is the discount bin of Big Tech right now, and the discount exists because of the antitrust cloud plus fears that AI capex (\$60B+ this year) won't pay off.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$549.90
12M Price Target	\$640.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.4%
Market Cap	\$1.40T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$224M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	20.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$590.00	\$560.00	\$515.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$610.00	\$490.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$640.00	\$470.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$720.00	\$450.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$900.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1300.00	\$600.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare (+4.33% on the week) are catching a bid — likely rotation out of frothy tech ahead of Nvidia earnings. Defensive positioning.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (META's sector) is up only 0.65% and down 1.37% on the week — meaning the whole ad/media/social complex is being sold. That's a sector-level headwind, not just a META problem.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of mega-cap tech and INTO defensives and cyclicals — classic pre-Nvidia-earnings de-risking. If Nvidia delivers Wednesday, expect tech to snap back and META gets a beta bounce.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the antitrust fear is overblown, Alphabet (GOOGL) trades on the same theme with its own DOJ case — same setup, same discount, potentially same rebound.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): The whole market is holding its breath for their earnings — they're the AI trade's referee, and META is a huge NVDA customer
- AVGO (Broadcom): Rebounding with Wall Street calling 25% AI upside — the picks-and-shovels play benefits regardless of which platform wins

META CONTEXT: META is lagging badly — down near 52-week lows while the S&P is near highs. That's either a screaming buy signal (mean reversion) or a warning (market knows something). Given insider selling into the trial, I lean toward "known overhang, priced in" rather than "something structurally broken."

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the risk/reward at these levels but I'm not pounding the table until I see the trial's direction; the setup is asymmetric to the upside.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — big enough to matter if it works, small enough that a bad ruling doesn't wreck your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Scale in between \$520-545. If it breaks \$520 on trial news, that's your gut-check moment — either double down or wait for the dust to settle around \$490.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst is trial resolution (next 6 months) plus AI monetization evidence (2026-2027 as Llama and business messaging turn into real revenue).

WHEN TO BAIL: Ad revenue growth drops below 10% year-over-year, OR the trial produces a forced divestiture with no appeal path, OR Zuckerberg's AI capex hits \$80B+ without visible ROI.

HEDGING: Buy some cheap out-of-the-money puts expiring in October — think of it as insurance during the trial. Costs you maybe 1-2% of your position to sleep well.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$966.78 ▼ 0.77%	12M Price Target \$1150.00	52-Week Range \$114.25 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$1.09T
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MU: Chinese Memory IPO Spooks, But CHIPS Act Moat Holds

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU dropped ~4.5% over the week and is down again today after a Chinese memory chip maker IPO'd — the market is worried China is closing the tech gap. But here's the thing: they're IPOing DRAM (the older stuff), not HBM (high-bandwidth memory, the AI chip). MU still basically has a duopoly with SK Hynix on the high-margin AI memory that Nvidia needs.
- Bloomberg piece on Nvidia's "friends and foes closing in" is spilling over — when Nvidia sneezes, MU catches a cold because ~60% of MU's growth story IS Nvidia's HBM demand.

WHY IT MATTERS

This selloff is more sentiment than substance. The Chinese IPO is a legitimate long-term threat but it's a 3-5 year concern, not a next-quarter concern — China still can't produce HBM3E at scale, and US export controls are actively preventing them from getting the ASML lithography machines they'd need. The bigger inference: with MU at 75% of its 52-week range and options flow showing a bullish put/call skew despite the price drop (unusual call buying at \$960 and \$970 strikes), smart money looks like it's using this dip to accumulate. Watch for MU's fiscal Q4 earnings in late September — if HBM guidance stays strong, this dip gets bought aggressively.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CHIPS Act is MU's single biggest tailwind — they've been awarded ~\$6.1B in direct grants to build fabs in Idaho and New York, and that money is actively flowing. The Trump administration has been ambivalent on CHIPS (threatened to claw it back earlier this year) but ultimately kept it because reshoring semiconductors is bipartisan gospel. The real thing to watch: rumored Commerce Department action to tighten HBM export controls to China further — that would be a direct tailwind for MU by locking Chinese buyers into domestic (weaker) alternatives while preserving MU's Western customer base. Also watch the Taiwan tariff situation; any escalation hurts TSMC/Nvidia and by extension MU's HBM demand.

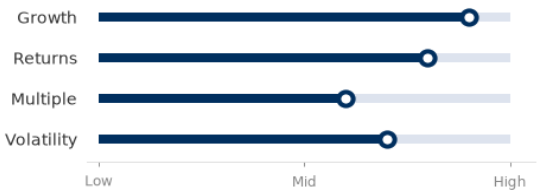
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$967 and roughly 65x trailing earnings, MU looks expensive on the surface — you're paying \$65 for every \$1 of last year's earnings. But memory is cyclical and earnings are exploding: on forward numbers you're paying more like 22-25x next year's earnings, which is reasonable for a company growing revenue 40%+ with expanding margins. Compared to Nvidia at ~40x forward, MU is actually the cheap way to play the AI infrastructure trade.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$966.78
12M Price Target	\$1150.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.0%
Market Cap	\$1.09T
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.80
FY2027E EPS	\$21.50
Fwd P/E	65.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1080.00	\$990.00	\$880.00
6 Months	\$1300.00	\$1150.00	\$850.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1150.00	\$780.00
2 Years	\$1900.00	\$1400.00	\$700.00
5 Years	\$2800.00	\$1800.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$4500.00	\$2500.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) leading today — likely a reflation trade tied to Bessent's Iran presser and oil dynamics. Healthcare grinding higher on defensive rotation.

COOLING OFF: Tech/semis are the notable absence from the leaderboard today — money is rotating OUT of crowded AI trades on the China competition headline.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic late-summer risk-off day — money moving from high-beta semis into materials and healthcare. Not a fundamental shift, more a positioning reset before September Fed meeting.

RELATED PLAY: If you like MU's HBM thesis, look at Applied Materials (AMAT) and Lam Research (LRCX) — they sell the equipment that MAKES the HBM chips, and they benefit whether MU, Samsung, or SK Hynix wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the anchor tenant of the AI trade — but "foes closing in" narrative today is a warning shot.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning the custom AI chip battle with hyperscalers, taking share of the ASIC market.

MU CONTEXT: MU is lagging peers today on the China IPO news specifically — this is stock-specific weakness, not sector weakness. That's actually a better setup for a bounce because it's a discrete, addressable concern rather than a broad AI unwind. If MU underperforms into earnings, it becomes a coiled spring.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — HBM duopoly + CHIPS Act moat + AI capex tailwind is a rare trifecta, but memory cyclicalilty keeps me from 10.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — the upside is real but memory stocks can drop 40% in a cycle downturn, so size accordingly.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd start a position around \$940-960 and add aggressively on any pullback to \$900. The \$880 level is where the 200-day trend support likely sits.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is fiscal Q4 earnings (late September) and HBM4 design win announcements with Nvidia's next-gen platform.

WHEN TO BAIL: If MU loses HBM qualification with Nvidia, if hyperscaler capex guidance turns negative, or if Chinese HBM3 samples appear commercially — any one of those and I'm cutting.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is to buy a put option 10% below current price expiring after next earnings — costs you maybe 3% but caps your downside if the earnings print disappoints. Or just don't oversize the position.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$362.86 ▲ 5.14%	12M Price Target \$400.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.43T
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TSLA: Robotaxi Momentum Meets EV Credit Cliff

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA ripped +5.1% on massive volume (59M shares, ~2x the recent average) — the headline catalyst is the Nevada robotaxi expansion. This matters because the market has essentially decided TSLA is an AI/autonomy story now, not a car company — every incremental city they add gets priced like a mini-IPO of a ride-share business.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — call buyers piled into \$350-360 strikes at 5-8x normal open interest (meaning traders bought way more upside bets than usual). That \$37M notional call bet at the \$350 strike tells you institutions were positioning for exactly this move.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real story: TSLA is trading like autonomy is inevitable, but the auto business underneath is quietly getting squeezed. The federal \$7,500 EV tax credit expired last September under the Trump administration's rollback, and Q3/Q4 delivery numbers are going to reflect that headwind — so the robotaxi narrative HAS to keep delivering to justify the multiple. The Nevada expansion is a signal Tesla is picking permissive-regulation states first (Texas, Nevada, Arizona) to build a track record before tackling California and the Northeast. Watch this closely: if Musk's public feud with Trump escalates further, there's real risk of retaliatory regulatory scrutiny on FSD (Full Self-Driving) — the NHTSA investigations are already open and could be weaponized.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest policy overhang is the expired federal EV tax credit — that \$7,500 consumer subsidy is gone, and it hits Tesla's US demand directly (analysts estimate 5-8% volume drag). On the positive side, the administration's federal AV (autonomous vehicle) framework is expected to preempt state-by-state patchwork rules, which would be a massive tailwind for Tesla's robotaxi rollout — Musk has been lobbying hard for this. Also watch China tariffs: Tesla's Shanghai gigafactory exports to Europe, and any escalation in the US-China trade fight complicates their global supply chain, particularly for battery materials.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$363, TSLA trades at roughly 169x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$169 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year. For context, Toyota trades at ~10x and even Nvidia is around 35x. That premium only makes sense if you believe robotaxi and Optimus (their humanoid robot) become real revenue lines within 3 years — otherwise this is one of the most expensive large-caps in the market.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

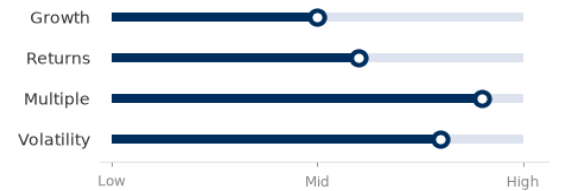
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-24 13:27 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$362.86
12M Price Target	\$400.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.2%
Market Cap	\$1.43T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$132M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	168.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$395.00	\$370.00	\$335.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$385.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$400.00	\$280.00
2 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$1400.00	\$700.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.1%) and Healthcare (+1.3%) — Materials is riding infrastructure spending and rare earth reshoring policy, Healthcare is bouncing on the Medicare drug pricing framework being softer than feared.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is flat over 5 days despite today's pop — retail spending is showing cracks and tariff pass-through to consumer prices is starting to bite.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO autonomy/AI-adjacent names within Cons Disc rather than traditional retail — TSLA is the biggest beneficiary of that intra-sector rotation.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the robotaxi story, the picks-and-shovels play is NVIDIA (compute for FSD training) and lidar/sensor names — though ironically Tesla famously doesn't use lidar, so stick with the AI compute angle.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the default AI winner — every autonomy story ultimately routes through their chips.
- GOOGL (Alphabet/Waymo): The other serious robotaxi player, already operating at scale in more cities than Tesla.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is leading the auto peer group by a mile today (XPeng dropped on earnings, legacy autos are flat), but lagging pure-play AI names on a YTD basis. That tells me the market is giving Tesla partial credit for autonomy but not full credit yet — which is either the opportunity or the warning, depending on whether robotaxi actually scales.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Cautiously constructive; the autonomy optionality is real but the valuation leaves zero room for error.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — high enough to matter if the robotaxi thesis plays out, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$320-340 — the stock is only 33% through its 52-week range, so chasing at \$363 after a 5% pop feels late.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you need at least that long for robotaxi to show real revenue in the 10-Q filings.

WHEN TO BAIL: If auto gross margins drop below 15%, if a major FSD incident triggers federal action, or if robotaxi expansion stalls for 2+ quarters.

HEDGING: Buy 6-month put options 10-15% below current price — think of it as insurance that pays off if the AI narrative cracks. Or simply keep position size small and hold cash on the side to average down.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$214.72 ▼ 0.98%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.20T
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NVDA: Cooling Into Earnings, But Setup Still Bullish

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA has quietly bled about 4.5% over five straight down days into Wednesday's earnings — that's classic pre-print de-risking, meaning big investors are trimming exposure so they don't get blown up by a surprise. Not a fundamental red flag, just nerves.
- Dan Ives is out calling the 15% AI server price hike "bullish" — translation: NVDA has so much pricing power that customers are eating a double-digit price increase without pushing back. That's a moat, not a warning sign.

WHY IT MATTERS

The options market is flashing bearish (put/call ratio 0.56 with unusual put buying at \$215 and \$227.50 strikes), which tells me institutions are hedging into earnings — they're not selling the stock outright, they're buying insurance. That's actually a healthier setup than pure euphoria because it means expectations are getting reset lower right before the print. If NVDA beats and guides even in-line, those puts get torched and you get a squeeze back to \$230+. The bigger picture: with server prices going UP 15% and hyperscaler capex still climbing, the demand side of this story hasn't cracked — the only question is whether Jensen can keep threading the needle on China export rules and supply.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single biggest policy variable is the Trump administration's evolving China chip export framework — the current "H2O revenue-share" arrangement (where NVDA reportedly hands over 15% of China AI chip revenue to keep selling there) is still being negotiated, and any tightening could shave billions off the top line. On the tailwind side, the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and the administration's AI infrastructure push (the "Stargate"-adjacent federal AI buildout) keep the domestic demand story intact. Watch also the EU AI Act enforcement kicking in — it's more of a compliance headache than an existential threat, and NVDA's scale means they can absorb it while smaller competitors can't.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

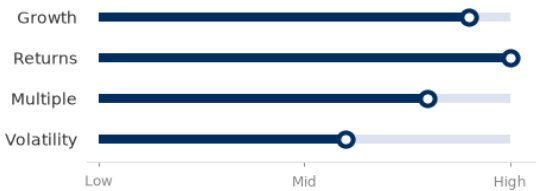
At ~\$215, NVDA trades around 37x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$37 for every \$1 of profit they'll make next year. That sounds expensive, but they're growing earnings 40%+, so the PEG ratio (price relative to growth) is actually under 1, which is cheap for a market leader. Compare that to Palantir at 200x+ or even AMD at 45x with slower growth — NVDA is arguably the most reasonably priced megacap AI name given what it actually earns.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$214.72
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.1%
Market Cap	\$5.20T
FY2027E Revenue	\$235M
FY2028E Revenue	\$295M
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
FY2028E EPS	\$7.40
Fwd P/E	36.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$220.00	\$195.00
6 Months	\$265.00	\$235.00	\$185.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$175.00
2 Years	\$360.00	\$290.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$380.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$550.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare (+4.33% on the week) — Materials is riding infrastructure spending and a weaker dollar; Healthcare is catching a bid on political de-risking around drug pricing rhetoric cooling off.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-1.37% weekly) and Financials (-1.17%) — Comm Services is the Meta antitrust trial overhang, Financials are pricing in Fed cut expectations squeezing net interest margins.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating OUT of mega-cap tech into cyclical and healthcare ahead of the NVDA print — this is defensive positioning, not conviction selling. If NVDA delivers, expect a sharp rotation back.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA guides strong, the second-order winners are the memory names (MU already flagged by Ives) and the power/cooling infrastructure plays like VRT and ETN — the AI data centers need HBM memory and liquid cooling, and those suppliers have less crowded trades.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MU (Micron): Ives specifically called them out as the sneaky beneficiary of the AI server price hike — HBM memory is supply-constrained and pricing power is transferring down the stack.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon for hyperscalers keeps grinding higher as customers diversify away from pure NVDA dependency.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is lagging its ecosystem slightly this week, which is unusual — it's the pre-earnings de-risking I mentioned. If NVDA prints well, it plays catch-up fast. If it disappoints, the whole AI complex re-rates lower with it, so don't get cute buying the "safer" derivatives.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$205-212 pre-earnings, or on any post-earnings dip toward \$200

Time Horizon: 12-18 months

Thesis Invalidation: Data center revenue growth decelerates below 40% YoY or China export controls tighten materially

Hedging: Buy protective puts into earnings or pair with a short in an overheated AI derivative name

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$344.82 ▲ 1.22%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$205.28 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.22T
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GOOGL: AI Trade Holds Steady, Antitrust Cloud Lingerling

WHAT HAPPENED

- Marvell earnings hit Wednesday and the big story there is their custom-chip deal with Google — meaning GOOGL's in-house TPU chips (the AI processors they design themselves instead of buying from Nvidia) are ramping. That's a big deal because it's how Alphabet dodges paying Nvidia's fat margins on every AI query.
- Nvidia reports Wednesday too, and it'll set the tone for the whole AI trade. If Nvidia guides strong, GOOGL rides the wave up. If Nvidia disappoints, expect a couple percent pullback across mega-cap AI names including this one.

WHY IT MATTERS

The tape is telling you something: GOOGL is grinding higher in a boring, low-volatility way at 69% of its 52-week range — that's institutional accumulation, not retail FOMO. Options flow is 2:1 calls-to-puts with unusual buying right at the \$345 strike, meaning big money is positioning for a break higher into Nvidia earnings. The Brin insider "transactions" at \$0 are almost certainly gifts or trust transfers (not open-market sales) — ignore the "bearish" label there. The real inference: the market is finally starting to price GOOGL as an AI winner rather than an AI victim, and the Marvell/TPU story reinforces that Alphabet is the only Big Tech player with its own silicon at scale besides Apple.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The overhang everyone's watching is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the judge already ruled Google monopolized search, and the remedy could range from mild (data-sharing rules) to nuclear (forced Chrome divestiture). The Trump administration's DOJ has actually softened its ask compared to the Biden version, which is a quiet tailwind. Also watch the AI executive order framework — the current White House is pushing "light-touch" AI regulation to keep the US ahead of China, which favors incumbents like GOOGL who already have compliance infrastructure while boxing out smaller competitors.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At roughly 35x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$35 for every \$1 of profit Alphabet is expected to make next year — GOOGL trades at a discount to MSFT (~32x but growing slower in cloud) and well below NVDA (~40x). For a company growing revenue 12-14% with 30%+ operating margins and a \$100B+ cash pile, that's reasonable, not cheap. The stock deserves a higher multiple if Google Cloud keeps taking share from AWS — which it's been doing for six straight quarters.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

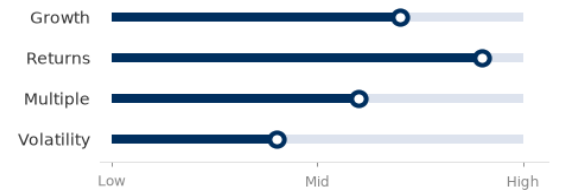
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-24 13:27 UTC

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Key Data

Price (USD)	\$344.82
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.7%
Market Cap	\$4.22T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$475M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	35.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$395.00	\$370.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$510.00	\$440.00	\$280.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare (+1.29%) are leading — that's a defensive-plus-cyclical rotation suggesting mixed macro views ahead of Fed/Nvidia week. AI infrastructure names (Broadcom, Marvell) are catching bids on custom-silicon deals.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services is only up 0.65% today and down 1.37% over 5 days — GOOGL is actually holding up better than its sector, which is a bullish tell.

ROTATION WATCH: Money's positioning defensively into Wednesday's Nvidia print and Friday's Jackson Hole Fed commentary. If Powell hints at September rate cuts, expect a mega-cap tech rip.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the TPU story, MRVL (Marvell) is the direct picks-and-shovels play — they co-design Google's custom chips. Also AVGO (Broadcom) does similar work for other hyperscalers.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): +25% AI upside call from the Street — custom silicon story is the same tailwind lifting GOOGL's TPU narrative.
- MRVL (Marvell): Riding into earnings on the Google deal — direct beneficiary of Alphabet's chip independence strategy.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is quietly leading its Comm Services sector (up while sector is flat over 5 days) but lagging the pure AI-infrastructure names. That's actually healthy — it means the stock is being re-rated as an AI winner without the froth. Room to catch up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Best risk/reward in mega-cap tech right now. Own the AI stack, trade at a discount to peers, and antitrust fears look overpriced.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a bad antitrust ruling doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$335-340. If Nvidia disappoints Wednesday and this trades to \$325, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalysts: cloud growth acceleration, TPU external customer announcements, and antitrust remedy clarity by mid-2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: Forced structural breakup announcement, cloud growth below 25%, or two consecutive quarters of search ad decline.

HEDGING: If you're nervous about the antitrust decision, buy some out-of-the-money puts 6 months out — think of it as insurance costing about 1-2% of your position value that pays off big if the ruling goes badly.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy \$237.04 ▼ 5.57% 12M Price Target \$285.00 52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88

Market Cap \$212.75B

MRVL: Earnings Thursday, Google TPU Deal is the Whole Story

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down 5.6% heading into a huge earnings print on Thursday (Aug 27) — this looks like nervous positioning, not fundamental bad news. When a stock rips from \$216 to \$251 in three days and then gives back \$14 the day before Nvidia earnings AND its own earnings, that's traders taking chips off the table, not smart money bailing.
- The whole story right now is the Google TPU (Tensor Processing Unit — Google's custom AI chip) partnership. Barron's is flagging it as THE talking point for earnings, meaning the market has already decided this deal makes or breaks the quarter.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: MRVL is being judged as "the other custom AI chip company" next to Broadcom (AVGO), and Wall Street is trying to figure out if MRVL deserves a similar premium. The Google deal matters because it validates MRVL as a legitimate second source for hyperscaler custom silicon — if management confirms revenue ramp specifics Thursday, this stock re-rates higher fast. But the setup is dangerous: options flow shows unusual put buying at \$177.50 and \$182.50 (way below current price), meaning some big player is hedging against a nasty earnings miss. Translation: the risk/reward into Thursday is asymmetric — huge upside if Google numbers are concrete, painful downside if guidance is vague.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

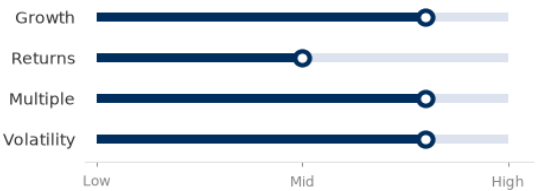
The CHIPS Act (the 2022 law that hands out federal money to semiconductor companies building in the US) remains the backbone tailwind here — MRVL benefits indirectly because its hyperscaler customers are getting subsidies to build domestic AI infrastructure. Watch the Trump administration's ongoing China export controls: the recent expansion of restrictions on advanced AI chips to China cuts both ways for MRVL — it hurts their China revenue directly, but it also pushes US hyperscalers to double-down on domestic custom silicon suppliers like MRVL and AVGO. Also on the radar: any executive action on AI infrastructure permitting (data center power/grid), because if that gets streamlined, hyperscaler capex accelerates and MRVL is a direct beneficiary.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$237.04
12M Price Target	\$285.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.2%
Market Cap	\$212.75B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2028E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	83.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$275.00	\$245.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$265.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$350.00	\$285.00	\$175.00
2 Years	\$425.00	\$320.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2.14%) and Healthcare are catching a bid — this is defensive rotation ahead of Nvidia earnings and inflation data, classic "de-risk from tech" behavior. Not a great tape for MRVL today.

COOLING OFF: Semis and broader tech are quiet-to-down as everyone waits on Nvidia Wednesday night — nobody wants to be a hero before that print sets the tone for the whole AI complex.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is temporarily sitting in defensives waiting for the Nvidia + inflation data double-header. Once those clear, if Nvidia beats, expect a violent rotation back into AI names including MRVL.

RELATED PLAY: If you like MRVL's thesis but want less binary risk, look at the AI infrastructure picks-and-shovels — companies like Vertiv (VRT) for data center power/cooling, or the semiconductor equipment names (AMAT, LRCX) that sell to everyone regardless of which chip wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Rebounding today with analysts flagging 25% AI upside — Broadcom is the "safer" custom silicon play and gets the benefit of the doubt.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Everyone positioning for Wednesday's earnings; if they blow it out, MRVL rides the wave Thursday.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is lagging AVGO today, which is normal — Broadcom is the incumbent, MRVL is the challenger. If MRVL earnings validate the Google deal Thursday, expect the valuation gap to AVGO to compress fast. That's the trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the long-term AI custom silicon story, but I'd be lying if I said I had high conviction 48 hours before earnings.

POSITION SIZE: Keep it 2-4% — this is a high-beta AI name with binary earnings risk. Don't oversize into Thursday.

ENTRY POINTS: If you don't own it, wait for the earnings dust to settle. A post-earnings pullback to \$215-225 would be a gift; chasing above \$260 pre-earnings is asking for pain.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months — the catalyst is the Google TPU revenue ramp showing up in numbers over the next 2-3 quarters.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Thursday brings a big Google deal disappointment, or if the FY27 revenue guide comes in below \$8B, cut the position. Also bail if hyperscaler capex guidance from Meta/Google/Amazon starts rolling over in Q4.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a small amount of MRVL puts a bit below current price to cap your earnings downside, or just size the position small enough that a 20% gap down doesn't ruin your week.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$141.39 · 1M: +31.8% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.8B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
2	SMCI Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$37.24 · 1M: +21.9% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$24.1B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$42 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
3	GTLB GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$41.67 · 1M: +32.9% · P/S: 7.0x · Cap: \$7.0B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
4	PATH UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$16.39 · 1M: +53.2% · P/S: 5.1x · Cap: \$8.5B			
■ Monitor for pullback to \$14 entry			
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL			
5	KTOS Kratos Defense & Security Solutions Defense Technology	7.8/10	BUY
Price: \$57.17 · 1M: +19.4% · P/S: 7.0x · Cap: \$10.7B			
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt			
OPT:NEUT INS:NEUT INST:BULL			